

Object Downed
Above Alaska
By the Military

U.S. Officials Not Sure
if It Was a Balloon

This article is by **Helene Cooper**, **Julian E. Barnes** and **Edward Wong**.
WASHINGTON — The Pentagon said it shot down an unidentified object over frozen waters around Alaska on Friday at the order of President Biden, less than a week after a U.S. fighter jet brought down a Chinese spy balloon over the Atlantic in an episode that increased tensions between Washington and Beijing. U.S. officials said they could not immediately confirm whether the object was a balloon, but it was traveling at an altitude that made it a potential threat to civilian aircraft. At a news conference on Friday, John F. Kirby, a White House spokesman, said Mr. Biden ordered the unidentified object near Alaska downed “out of an abundance of caution.” The Friday shootdown showed Mr. Biden taking direct and forceful action far more quickly than he did last week, when some Republican lawmakers criticized him for letting the spy balloon linger over the United States for several days before destroying it. But that period of observation last week allowed American officials to collect intelligence about the spy balloon, while in the episode on Friday, officials seemed unsure about what exactly they shot down. Pentagon officials said they were able to immediately bring down the object over water, so they could easily avoid the dilemma posed by the spy balloon drifting over populated areas, which had prompted commanders to recommend to Mr. Biden to wait to shoot down the machine in order to avoid any chance of debris hitting people on the ground. Three U.S. officials said that as of Friday evening, the government did not know who owned or sent the object seen above Alaska, which, like the Chinese balloon last week, was shot down by an F-22 fighter jet using a Sidewinder air-to-air missile. Several officials said they believed the object shot down Friday was a balloon, but a Defense Department official said it broke into pieces when it hit the frozen sea, which added to the mystery of whether it was indeed a balloon, a drone or something else. Mr. Kirby said that the object

Continued on Page A6

Sports Betting
Crimps Lifeline
Tribes Rely On

This article is by **David W. Chen**, **Mark Walker** and **Kenneth P. Vogel**.
For decades, gambling has been the most important source of income for hundreds of Native American tribes. Now, in many parts of the country, the rapid

A RISKY WAGER
Economies Upended

spread of sports betting and on-line wagering is threatening to crimp that economic lifeline. In Florida, the powerful Seminole tribe forged a lucrative deal to exclusively offer sports betting in the state, only to have the deal blocked by a lawsuit from casino companies. In the Upper Peninsula of Michigan, one tribe saw its gambling revenue decline sharply last year because of chaos in the online betting business. And in Arizona, traditional casinos and sports teams gobbled up

Continued on Page A10

INTERNATIONAL A4-8

Fatal Attack in East Jerusalem
A 6-year-old was among those killed when man drove into a group of civilians outside an Israeli settlement. PAGE A7

Ukrainian Mayor at War
Being Kherson’s leader may feel more like a curse than an honor as the Russians shell her city incessantly. PAGE A4



NATIONAL A9-17, 20

A Beating, Blow by Blow
An analysis of video footage shows the six Memphis officers charged in the beating death of Tyre Nichols resorted to force immediately. PAGE A9

Pence’s Home Is Searched
After five hours at the former vice president’s residence in Indiana, the F.B.I. turned up only one more classified document. PAGE A15

DeSantis Takes Aims at Media
The Florida governor is the latest Republican to target the Supreme Court decision that has long protected journalists accused of defamation. PAGE A13

SPORTS B7-11

A Contrast in the Super Bowl
Philadelphia’s Jalen Hurts and Kansas City’s Patrick Mahomes starred with different styles on the way to a historic matchup. PAGE B7

Failure Amid Progress
The Super Bowl quarterbacks are Black. And there has been a surge of Black executives, but not of Black coaches. Sports of The Times. PAGE B8

Baseball at the Big Game
The Mets, arguing that the Super Bowl “really kicks off the baseball season,” are running a 30-second commercial during Sunday’s broadcast. PAGE B11

BUSINESS B1-6

DeSantis Claims Win vs. Disney
The company kept a special tax district, but lost control of who sits on that tax board to Florida’s governor. PAGE B1

Floodgates Open for Beer Ads
Anheuser-Busch no longer has a lock on Super Bowl commercials. Below, Paul Rudd in a spot for Heineken. PAGE B6



MISSILES SHOWER
A UKRAINE IN NEED
OF MILITARY AID

OVER 100 AIRSTRIKES

Russian Blitz Comes on
Heels of Zelensky’s
Pleas to Allies

By **MARC SANTORA**
KYIV, Ukraine — Russia targeted Ukraine’s already battered infrastructure with more than 100 drones, rockets and missiles on Friday, raining explosives on cities around the country as President Volodymyr Zelensky returned from a three-day trip across Europe to ask Ukraine’s allies to send more weapons, and faster. The strikes, the first heavy aerial barrage in weeks, came as fighting on the ground intensified, in what Ukrainian officials were calling a new winter offensive. Russia has been pouring troops and equipment into eastern Ukraine, in the first stage of what Ukrainian and Western officials say will be a major push to swallow up more of the Donbas region before Kyiv can field more powerful armaments from the West and mount its own offensive. The fighting has been especially heavy around the Russian-occupied city of Kreminna and the Ukrainian-held city of Bakhmut, about 30 miles apart in the Donbas, the mineral-rich region in the country’s east where separatists had waged a yearslong campaign to break away from Ukraine before the invasion. Russia has made small tactical gains over the past week, amid intense combat and heavy casualties on both sides, military analysts said, but as of Friday there was no evidence of a major breakthrough. The Ukrainian air force described Friday’s aerial assault as a “massive attack” and said that it had involved 71 cruise missiles, seven Iranian-made drones and about 35 S-300 missiles, anti-aircraft missiles that Russia has taken to using against targets on the ground. Ukraine said in a statement that it had shot down 61 of the cruise missiles and five of the drones, but it does not have the capability to intercept the S-300. “Their targets were civilians, civilian infrastructure,” Mr. Zelensky, who was traveling back to

Continued on Page A5



SERGEY PONOMAREV FOR THE NEW YORK TIMES

In Turkey, a Web of Volunteer Medics
In place of demolished hospitals, a series of field clinics has sprung up, staffed by doctors and nurses from around the world. Page A8.

Democrats Hope Big-Ticket Bills
Will Bolster Their Labor Support

By **JONATHAN WEISMAN**
BRIDGEPORT, W.Va. — In the mid-1970s, when Mark Raddish wasn’t more than 11 years old, his coal-mining grandfather picked him up from a mining camp and took him a thousand feet underground, to the cold darkness beneath West Virginia. There, he imparted a lesson. “You don’t want to make this your livelihood,” warned his grandfather, a union miner, Mr. Raddish recalled. “These guys don’t know if they’re going to come home at night to see their mom or dad, to see their brothers and sisters or their little boy or girl.” He did as he was told, getting an education and landing a pipe fitters’ union job for Mylan Pharmaceuticals. When that job was sent overseas, he took a leap of faith late last year and signed on as West Virginia Employee No. 2 for Sparkz, a California-based electric vehicle battery start-up. The company was enticed here, in the

Encouraging Hiring of
Union Members to
Get Subsidies

wooded hills outside Bridgeport, W.Va., in part by generous federal tax subsidies and in part by the United Mine Workers of America, which is recruiting out-of-work coal miners for the company’s new plant in a faded industrial park. It is no accident that this plant, rising in place of a shuttered plate-glass factory, is bringing yet another alternative-energy company to rural West Virginia. Federal money is pouring into the growing industry, with thick strings attached to reward companies that pay union wages, employ union apprentices and buy American steel, iron and components. President Biden and the Democrats who pushed those provisions

Continued on Page A13

Pitching Benefits for Families,
From a Corner of Conservatism

By **DANA GOLDSTEIN**
Sending cash to parents, with few strings attached. Expanding Medicaid. Providing child care subsidies to families earning six figures. The ideas may sound like part of a progressive platform. But they are from an influential group of conservative intellectuals with a direct line to elected politicians. They hope to represent the future of a post-Trump Republican Party — if only, they say, their fellow travelers would abandon Reaganomics once and for all. These conservatives generally oppose abortion rights. They’re eager to promote marriage, they worry about the nation’s declining fertility rate and they often resist the trans rights movement. But they also acknowledge that with abortion now illegal or tightly restricted in half the states, more babies will be born to parents struggling to pay for the basics — rent, health care, groceries and child care — when prices are high

In the Post-Roe World,
Some See the Need
for Federal Aid

and child care slots scarce. “A full-spectrum family policy has to be about encouraging and supporting people in getting married and starting families,” said Oren Cass, executive director of the American Compass think tank. “It has to be pro-life, but also supportive of those families as they are trying to raise kids in an economic environment where that has become a lot harder to do.” The idea of spending heavily on family benefits remains an outlier within the Republican Party, which only recently rejected Democrats’ attempts to extend pandemic-era child tax credits. But a number of conservative members of Congress have embraced

Continued on Page A14

Adapting to Congress, and to Life After a Stroke

By **ANNIE KARNI**
WASHINGTON — At Senator John Fetterman’s desk in the Senate chamber, there is a newly installed monitor that rises or lowers, depending on whether he sits or stands, and provides closed captioning so he can follow the proceedings. At the center dais, a custom desk stand has been built to accommodate the same technology for when he takes his shifts presiding over the Senate. The sergeant-at-arms has arranged for live audio-to-text transcription for the committees on which Mr. Fetterman serves, and plans to expand the service to all Senate hearings. Mr. Fetterman, 53, the 6-foot-8, tattooed and goateed Democrat from Pennsylvania who had a near-fatal stroke last May and went on to win one of the most competitive seats in November’s midterm elections, was never going to blend in seamlessly in the marbled corridors of Congress. But his adjustment to serving in the Senate has been made vastly more difficult by the strains of his recovery, which left him with a physical impairment and serious mental health challenges that



KENNY HOLSTON/THE NEW YORK TIMES

Senator John Fetterman left a hospital on Friday after a bout of lightheadedness. He had a near-fatal stroke last May.

have rendered the transition extraordinarily challenging — even with the accommodations that have been made to help him adapt. “What you’re supposed to do to recover from this is do as little as possible,” said Adam Jentleson, his chief of staff. Instead, Mr. Fetterman “was forced to do as much as possible — he had to get back to the campaign trail. It’s hard to

claw that back.” On Wednesday, Mr. Fetterman was hospitalized after feeling lightheaded while attending a daylong Senate Democratic retreat in Washington. Initial tests showed no sign of another stroke, but he spent two days in a hospital while doctors ran additional tests to confirm that finding and monitored him for seizures, according to

Continued on Page A16

ARTS C1-6

Controversy in a Fantasy World
A “Harry Potter” video game has gamers divided over whether they should play it at all. PAGE C1

Dim Bulbs Light Up Stages
More than a few comedians play dumb smartly, and win a large share of laughs for their efforts. PAGE C1

OPINION A18-19

Elle Mills PAGE A19

